

NITI AAYOG

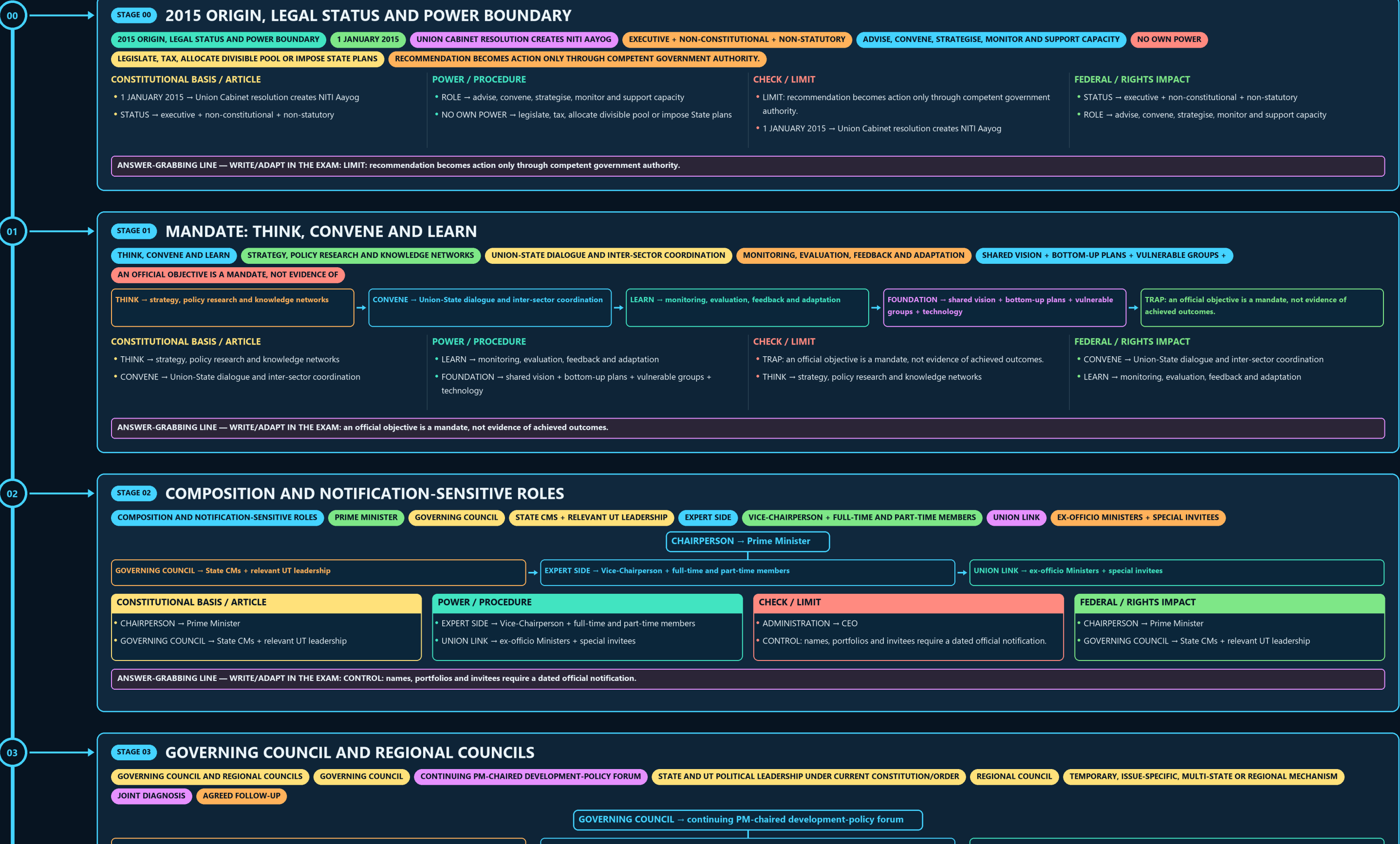
2015 ORIGIN, LEGAL STATUS → MANDATE: THINK, CONVENE AND → COMPOSITION AND NOTIFICATION-SENSITIVE ROLES → GOVERNING COUNCIL AND REGIONAL → PLANNING COMMISSION TRANSITION → COOPERATIVE AND COMPETITIVE FEDERALISM

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g4 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



03

STAGE 03 GOVERNING COUNCIL AND REGIONAL COUNCILS

GOVERNING COUNCIL AND REGIONAL COUNCILS GOVERNING COUNCIL CONTINUING PM-CHAired DEVELOPMENT-POLICY FORUM STATE AND UT POLITICAL LEADERSHIP UNDER CURRENT CONSTITUTION/ORDER REGIONAL COUNCIL TEMPORARY, ISSUE-SPECIFIC, MULTI-STATE OR REGIONAL MECHANISM

JOINT DIAGNOSIS AGREED FOLLOW-UP

GOVERNING COUNCIL → continuing PM-chaired development-policy forum

MEMBERS → State and UT political leadership under current constitution/order

REGIONAL COUNCIL → temporary, issue-specific, multi-State or regional mechanism

PROCESS → agenda → joint diagnosis → consultation → agreed follow-up

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- GOVERNING COUNCIL → continuing PM-chaired development-policy forum
- MEMBERS → State and UT political leadership under current constitution/order

POWER / PROCEDURE

- REGIONAL COUNCIL → temporary, issue-specific, multi-State or regional mechanism
- PROCESS → agenda → joint diagnosis → consultation → agreed follow-up

CHECK / LIMIT

- LIMIT: consensus is political coordination, not binding law or a State veto.
- GOVERNING COUNCIL → continuing PM-chaired development-policy forum

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- MEMBERS → State and UT political leadership under current constitution/order
- REGIONAL COUNCIL → temporary, issue-specific, multi-State or regional mechanism

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT: consensus is political coordination, not binding law or a State veto.

04

STAGE 04 PLANNING COMMISSION TRANSITION

PLANNING COMMISSION TRANSITION BOTH BODIES AROSE THROUGH EXECUTIVE RESOLUTION PLANNING COMMISSION FIVE-YEAR PLANS + PLAN-RESOURCE INFLUENCE + CENTRAL NEGOTIATION INDICATIVE STRATEGY + FEDERAL DIALOGUE + MONITORING + KNOWLEDGE LATER REFORM

PLAN/NON-PLAN BUDGET DISTINCTION ENDED SEPARATELY DIRECTIVE ALLOCATION SHIFTED TOWARD ADVISORY COORDINATION AND SOFTER LEVERAGE.

CONTINUITY → both bodies arose through executive resolution

PLANNING COMMISSION → Five-Year Plans + plan-resource influence + central negotiation

NITI → indicative strategy + federal dialogue + monitoring + knowledge

LATER REFORM → plan/non-plan budget distinction ended separately

VERDICT: directive allocation shifted toward advisory coordination and softer leverage.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- CONTINUITY → both bodies arose through executive resolution
- PLANNING COMMISSION → Five-Year Plans + plan-resource influence + central negotiation

POWER / PROCEDURE

- NITI → indicative strategy + federal dialogue + monitoring + knowledge
- LATER REFORM → plan/non-plan budget distinction ended separately

CHECK / LIMIT

- VERDICT: directive allocation shifted toward advisory coordination and softer leverage.
- CONTINUITY → both bodies arose through executive resolution

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- PLANNING COMMISSION → Five-Year Plans + plan-resource influence + central negotiation
- NITI → indicative strategy + federal dialogue + monitoring + knowledge

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: directive allocation shifted toward advisory coordination and softer leverage.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: directive allocation shifted toward advisory coordination and softer leverage.

05

STAGE 05 COOPERATIVE AND COMPETITIVE FEDERALISM

COOPERATIVE AND COMPETITIVE FEDERALISM SHARED AGENDA + STATE VOICE + JOINT PROBLEM-SOLVING + COMMON INDICATOR ADMINISTRATIVE RESPONSE STATE SUPPORT POLICY AND INSTITUTIONAL CAPABILITY PARTNERSHIPS

CENTRAL AGENDA POWER + BOYCOTT/NON-ATTENDANCE + UNEQUAL CAPACITY + PARTICIPATION IMPROVES LEGITIMACY ONLY WHEN EVIDENCE AND FOLLOW-UP ARE

COOPERATIVE → shared agenda + State voice + joint problem-solving + capacity support

COMPETITIVE → common indicator → comparison → reputation → administrative response

STATE SUPPORT → policy and institutional capability partnerships

RISKS → central agenda power + boycott/non-attendance + unequal capacity + data gaming

BALANCE: participation improves legitimacy only when evidence and follow-up are credible.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- COOPERATIVE → shared agenda + State voice + joint problem-solving + capacity support
- COMPETITIVE → common indicator → comparison → reputation → administrative response

POWER / PROCEDURE

- STATE SUPPORT → policy and institutional capability partnerships
- RISKS → central agenda power + boycott/non-attendance + unequal capacity + data gaming

CHECK / LIMIT

- BALANCE: participation improves legitimacy only when evidence and follow-up are credible.
- COOPERATIVE → shared agenda + State voice + joint problem-solving + capacity support

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- COMPETITIVE → common indicator → comparison → reputation → administrative response
- STATE SUPPORT → policy and institutional capability partnerships

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BALANCE: participation improves legitimacy only when evidence and follow-up are credible.

06

STAGE 06 EVIDENCE, INDICATORS AND EVALUATION

EVIDENCE, INDICATORS AND EVALUATION VERIFIED DATA MONITORING AND EVALUATION SUPPORT SAFE REPORTING RANK + ABSOLUTE LEVEL + CHANGE + UNCERTAINTY + DASHBOARD MOVEMENT DOES NOT BY ITSELF ESTABLISH CAUSATION OR

OUTCOME → indicator → baseline → verified data → comparison

diagnosis → intervention → reassessment

DMEQ → monitoring and evaluation support

SAFE REPORTING → rank + absolute level + change + uncertainty + field evidence

06

STAGE 06 EVIDENCE, INDICATORS AND EVALUATION

EVIDENCE, INDICATORS AND EVALUATION

VERIFIED DATA

MONITORING AND EVALUATION SUPPORT

SAFE REPORTING

RANK + ABSOLUTE LEVEL + CHANGE + UNCERTAINTY +

DASHBOARD MOVEMENT DOES NOT BY ITSELF ESTABLISH CAUSATION OR

OUTCOME → indicator → baseline → verified data → comparison

diagnosis → intervention → reassessment

DMEO → monitoring and evaluation support

SAFE REPORTING → rank + absolute level + change + uncertainty + field evidence

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- OUTCOME → indicator → baseline → verified data → comparison
- diagnosis → intervention → reassessment

POWER / PROCEDURE

- DMEO → monitoring and evaluation support
- SAFE REPORTING → rank + absolute level + change + uncertainty + field evidence

CHECK / LIMIT

- TRAP: dashboard movement does not by itself establish causation or durable welfare gain.
- OUTCOME → indicator → baseline → verified data → comparison

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- diagnosis → intervention → reassessment
- DMEO → monitoring and evaluation support

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: dashboard movement does not by itself establish causation or durable welfare gain.

07

STAGE 07 ASPIRATIONAL DISTRICTS AND BLOCKS

ASPIRATIONAL DISTRICTS AND BLOCKS

ALIGN SCHEMES AND AGENCIES

CENTRE + STATE + DISTRICT/BLOCK TEAMS

DELTA INDICATORS AND PEER COMPARISON

REMAINS WITH COMPETENT GOVERNMENTS AND FIELD ADMINISTRATION

NITI COORDINATES AND MONITORS; IT DOES NOT DIRECTLY DELIVER

CONVERGENCE → align schemes and agencies

COLLABORATION → Centre + State + district/block teams

COMPETITION → delta indicators and peer comparison

DELIVERY → remains with competent governments and field administration

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- CONVERGENCE → align schemes and agencies
- COLLABORATION → Centre + State + district/block teams

POWER / PROCEDURE

- COMPETITION → delta indicators and peer comparison
- DELIVERY → remains with competent governments and field administration

CHECK / LIMIT

- LIMIT: NITI coordinates and monitors; it does not directly deliver every service.
- CONVERGENCE → align schemes and agencies

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- COLLABORATION → Centre + State + district/block teams
- COMPETITION → delta indicators and peer comparison

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT: NITI coordinates and monitors; it does not directly deliver every service.

08

STAGE 08 SDGS, DMEO AND ATAL INNOVATION MISSION

SDGS, DMEO AND ATAL INNOVATION MISSION

SDG LOCALISATION

STATE/LOCAL ATTENTION

PROGRAMME MONITORING AND EVALUATION

INNOVATION INITIATIVE UNDER NITI; ARCHITECTURE IS DATE-SENSITIVE

PROGRAMME TEST

OWNER + MECHANISM + IMPLEMENTER + EVIDENCE + LIMIT

PYQ 2019

SDG LOCALISATION → goals → indicators → State/local attention

DMEO → programme monitoring and evaluation

AIM → innovation initiative under NITI; architecture is date-sensitive

PROGRAMME TEST → owner + mechanism + implementer + evidence + limit

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- SDG LOCALISATION → goals → indicators → State/local attention
- DMEO → programme monitoring and evaluation

POWER / PROCEDURE

- AIM → innovation initiative under NITI; architecture is date-sensitive
- PROGRAMME TEST → owner + mechanism + implementer + evidence + limit

CHECK / LIMIT

- PYQ 2019: institutional ownership matters more than the programme name.
- SDG LOCALISATION → goals → indicators → State/local attention

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- DMEO → programme monitoring and evaluation
- AIM → innovation initiative under NITI; architecture is date-sensitive

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PYQ 2019: institutional ownership matters more than the programme name.

09

STAGE 09 NITI AND NEIGHBOURING INSTITUTIONS

NITI AND NEIGHBOURING INSTITUTIONS

EXECUTIVE STRATEGY, DIALOGUE AND MONITORING

FINANCE COMMISSION

ARTICLE 280 FISCAL RECOMMENDATIONS

GST COUNCIL

ARTICLE 279A GST RECOMMENDATIONS

INTER-STATE COUNCIL

ARTICLE 263 COORDINATION ROUTE

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

NITI → executive strategy, dialogue and monitoring

FINANCE COMMISSION → Article 280 fiscal recommendations

POWER / PROCEDURE

GST COUNCIL → Article 279A GST recommendations

INTER-STATE COUNCIL → Article 263 coordination route

CHECK / LIMIT

ZONAL COUNCILS → statutory regional cooperation

STATE FINANCE COMMISSIONS → State-local fiscal recommendations

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

Never transfer one body's source or power to another.

NITI → executive strategy, dialogue and monitoring

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- NITI → executive strategy, dialogue and monitoring
- FINANCE COMMISSION → Article 280 fiscal recommendations

POWER / PROCEDURE

- GST COUNCIL → Article 279A GST recommendations
- INTER-STATE COUNCIL → Article 263 coordination route

CHECK / LIMIT

- ZONAL COUNCILS → statutory regional cooperation
- STATE FINANCE COMMISSIONS → State-local fiscal recommendations

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Never transfer one body's source or power to another.
- NITI → executive strategy, dialogue and monitoring

09

STAGE 09

NITI AND NEIGHBOURING INSTITUTIONS

NITI AND NEIGHBOURING INSTITUTIONS

EXECUTIVE STRATEGY, DIALOGUE AND MONITORING

FINANCE COMMISSION

ARTICLE 280 FISCAL RECOMMENDATIONS

GST COUNCIL

ARTICLE 279A GST RECOMMENDATIONS

INTER-STATE COUNCIL

ARTICLE 263 COORDINATION ROUTE

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
NITI → executive strategy, dialogue and monitoring	GST COUNCIL → Article 279A GST recommendations	ZONAL COUNCILS → statutory regional cooperation	Never transfer one body's source or power to another.
FINANCE COMMISSION → Article 280 fiscal recommendations	INTER-STATE COUNCIL → Article 263 coordination route	STATE FINANCE COMMISSIONS → State-local fiscal recommendations	NITI → executive strategy, dialogue and monitoring
CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE - NITI → executive strategy, dialogue and monitoring - FINANCE COMMISSION → Article 280 fiscal recommendations	POWER / PROCEDURE - GST COUNCIL → Article 279A GST recommendations - INTER-STATE COUNCIL → Article 263 coordination route	CHECK / LIMIT - ZONAL COUNCILS → statutory regional cooperation - STATE FINANCE COMMISSIONS → State-local fiscal recommendations	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT - Never transfer one body's source or power to another. - NITI → executive strategy, dialogue and monitoring

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Never transfer one body's source or power to another.

10

STAGE 10

STRENGTHS, DEFICITS AND ACCOUNTABLE REFORM

STRENGTHS, DEFICITS AND ACCOUNTABLE REFORM

FLEXIBILITY + EXPERTISE + CONVENING + CROSS-SECTOR EVIDENCE

NON-BINDING ADVICE + CENTRAL AGENDA + WEAK REPORTING +

STATE AGENDA WINDOWS + PUBLISHED CONSULTATIONS + INDEPENDENT DATA

ACTION TRACKING + PARLIAMENTARY VISIBILITY + IMPLEMENTATION FEEDBACK

RETAIN FLEXIBILITY WHILE MAKING INFLUENCE TRANSPARENT AND EVALUABLE.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
STRENGTHS → flexibility + expertise + convening + cross-sector evidence	REFORM → State agenda windows + published consultations + independent data audit	GOAL: retain flexibility while making influence transparent and evaluable.	DEFICITS → non-binding advice + central agenda + weak reporting + data risk
DEFICITS → non-binding advice + central agenda + weak reporting + data risk	action tracking + parliamentary visibility + implementation feedback	STRENGTHS → flexibility + expertise + convening + cross-sector evidence	REFORM → State agenda windows + published consultations + independent data audit
CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE - STRENGTHS → flexibility + expertise + convening + cross-sector evidence - DEFICITS → non-binding advice + central agenda + weak reporting + data risk	POWER / PROCEDURE - REFORM → State agenda windows + published consultations + independent data audit - action tracking + parliamentary visibility + implementation feedback	CHECK / LIMIT - GOAL: retain flexibility while making influence transparent and evaluable. - STRENGTHS → flexibility + expertise + convening + cross-sector evidence	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT - DEFICITS → non-binding advice + central agenda + weak reporting + data risk - REFORM → State agenda windows + published consultations + independent data audit

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GOAL: retain flexibility while making influence transparent and evaluable.

11

STAGE 11

PYQ ROUTES AND ANSWER SYNTHESIS

PYQ ROUTES AND ANSWER SYNTHESIS

PYQ 2018

NITI PRINCIPLES VERSUS PLANNING COMMISSION

PYQ 2019

ATAL INNOVATION MISSION INSTITUTIONAL LOCATION

FEDERAL MECHANISM

PROGRAMME EVIDENCE

FISCAL/DATA LIMITS

PYQ 2018 → NITI principles versus Planning Commission	→	PYQ 2019 → Atal Innovation Mission institutional location	→	PRELIMS → executive != unconstitutional	→	Council != legislature	→	index != power
CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE - PYQ 2018 → NITI principles versus Planning Commission - PYQ 2019 → Atal Innovation Mission institutional location		POWER / PROCEDURE - PRELIMS → executive != unconstitutional - Council != legislature		CHECK / LIMIT - index != power - MAINS → origin → mandate → composition → federal mechanism → programme evidence		FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT - fiscal/data limits → accountable reform → qualified verdict - NITI succeeds through credible persuasion, State ownership and implementation.		

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: fiscal/data limits → accountable reform → qualified verdict.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

INSTITUTIONAL ENRICHMENT

[ANALYSIS] THE KEY DESIGN TRADE-OFF IS FLEXIBILITY VERSUS ACCOUNTABLE

EXECUTIVE STATUS

PERMITS RAPID ADAPTATION BUT WEAKENS MANDATORY REPORTING AND STABLE

[ANALYSIS] COMPETITIVE FEDERALISM WORKS ONLY WHEN INDICATORS ARE COMPARABLE

[LIMIT] STATE PARTICIPATION IN THE GOVERNING COUNCIL DOES NOT

[LIMIT] PROGRAMME OWNERSHIP, INDEX EDITIONS AND MEETING THEMES ARE

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE

- Institutional enrichment
- [ANALYSIS] The key design trade-off is flexibility versus accountable permanence: executive status
- permits rapid adaptation but weakens mandatory reporting and stable intergovernmental procedure.

ADVANCED LIMIT

- [ANALYSIS] Competitive federalism works only when indicators are comparable, auditable and paired with absolute levels and field evidence.
- [LIMIT] State participation in the Governing Council does not create a State veto, binding compact or second federal chamber.
- [LIMIT] Programme ownership, index editions and meeting themes are dated evidence of institutional activity, not proof of outcomes.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- Institutional enrichment - [ANALYSIS] The key design trade-off is flexibility versus accountable permanence:
- executive status permits rapid adaptation but weakens mandatory reporting and stable intergovernmental procedure.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.